

**Q1: Highlight the elements from the Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) that have influenced the contemporary culture of the Indian subcontinent. (10 Marks, 150 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** Start with a brief introduction about Harappan Civilization.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlighting the elements of IVC that have influenced the present-day culture of Indian subcontinent.

**Conclusion:** Conclude with summarizing Cultural Influence of IVC on present day.

**Answer:** The Harappan or Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) was a Bronze Age civilization, with its mature phase lasting approximately from 2600 BCE to 1900 BCE. IVC was one of the world's earliest urban cultures, has profoundly influenced contemporary Indian subcontinent culture.

**Cultural influence of the Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) on present-day culture:**

- **Religious Worship/Practices:** The worship of ancient deities such as Mother Goddess reflects during Navratri and Durga Pooja, and the Pashupati seal reflecting the reverence for Shiva.
- **Performing Arts:** The "Dancing Girl" statue from Mohenjodaro highlights the significance of dance in that era, and today, we have eight classical dances inspired by our ancient culture.
- **Fashion:** The Apparel from the IVC, like the shawl-like clothing on the "Bearded Priest" statue, remains culturally relevant today. Similarly, the tradition of wearing ornaments such as bangles, beads, and amulets continues from IVC practices.
- **Agriculture:** The IVC cultivated wheat, barley, and cotton which laid the foundation for agricultural practices that persist today. Techniques like crop rotation and irrigation, observed in ancient times, are still in use.
- **Urban Planning:** Planned cities and efficient drainage systems are direct influences of the IVC.
- **Language and Script:** Although the IVC script hasn't been deciphered. Symbols and motifs from IVC can be seen in modern Indian languages and scripts, indicating a cultural connection.

The Indus Valley Civilization's contributions are foundational to many aspects of contemporary Indian culture, reflecting a blend of ancient innovation and modern adaptation.

**Additional Information:**

- **Water Management:** The IVC had advanced water management systems, such as wells and reservoirs. These innovations continue to impact modern water conservation and management techniques in India.
- **Scientific Influences:**
  - **Weights and Measures:** The IVC had a standardized system of weights and measures.
  - **Numerical Systems:** The concept of numbers and numerical systems was evident in the IVC, as seen in the standardized dimensions of bricks with a 4:2:1 ratio.

**Q2: What insights do ancient Indian literature provide about the role and status of women in ancient society? (10 Marks, 150 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** Start with a brief journey of about women from the beginning of ancient time till the end.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlight by focusing on the status of women rather than men and to use literature as a primary source to support your answer.

**Conclusion:** Summarizes the contribution of women during ancient period and the inspiration they give to present generation women.

**Answer:** The status of women in ancient India varied by time, region, and social class. They experienced a range of roles, from revered deities to subservient figures and even sati.

**Role and Status of Women in Ancient Literature:**

- **Rig Veda:** Women in the Rig Vedic period could join the Sabha and Vidhata, enjoying respect in society. There is no mention of child marriage, indicating they had opportunities for self-actualization.
- **Vedic Text:** The governance of queens like Lopamudra, Gargi and Maitreyi in Vedic texts highlighted their roles in intellectual and political discourse.
- **The Puranas:** During this period, women's status declined. Many women, known as Devadasis, lived in temples, danced, and worshipped gods, relying on men for livelihood.
- **Dharmashastra:** In the later Vedic period, women's status further declined due to their dependence on men, as the economy shifted from cattle to agriculture and land.
- **Anguttara Nikaya:** This Buddhist text highlights women's emancipation and equal status, showing that Buddhism appreciated womanhood.
- **The Manusmriti:** This legal text outlines women's duties but also imposes strict restrictions, denying them equal rights and opportunities compared to men.
- **Sangam Literature:** Sangam literature reveals, female courtiers, administrators and poetess were respected for their role. Avvaiyar, a famous poetess, is celebrated for her wisdom and literary contributions.
- **Arthashastra:** The Arthashastra mentions women engaged in trade and commerce, illustrating their economic autonomy.

Ancient Indian literature offers profound insights into the role and status of women, depicting their significant contributions in various spheres, their revered positions, and the societal norms governing their lives in ancient Indian society.

**Q3: Gandhara art was a hybrid school that reflects the cultural interaction between India and the Hellenistic world. Elaborate. (10 Marks, 150 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** Start by describing the Gandhara school of art.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlighting the elements of Gandhara school that depict cultural contact between India and the Hellenistic world.

**Conclusion:** Summarizes the contribution of Gandhar Art of School on Indian Culture.

**Answer:** Gandhara art emerged around the 1st century BCE in the Gandhara region (present-day Northwest Pakistan and Kabul valley). It developed from cultural exchanges between India and the Hellenistic world, particularly influenced by the Indo-Greek kingdoms established after Alexander the Great's conquests.

**Gandhara art represents a blend of Indian and Hellenistic styles:**

- **Synergy of Styles:** Gandhara art combined Greco-Roman and Indian artistic techniques.
  - Example, it adopted the sense of realism from Hellenistic art, and incorporating the idealistic depiction of human forms from Indian style.
- **Cosmopolitan Influences:** Gandhara art integrated various traditions such as Greek-style drapery and depictions of mythological scenes, like Herakles slaying the lion, etc.
- **Iconography:** Gandhara art used olive leaves to decorate Buddhist stupas and portraying the Buddha with curly hair, like the Greek god Apollo. Indian elements such as mudras and asanas were also present.
- **Materials:** Artists used grey schist, a local material that allowed for detailed and realistic portrayals. This was influenced by Hellenistic sculptural techniques.
- **Religious Syncretism:** Gandhara art reflected religious blending, depicting deities from Buddhism, Greco-Roman mythology, and Hinduism.
  - Examples include figures like Skanda and Shiva alongside Buddhist and Greco-Roman gods.
- **Artistic Impact:** Gandhara art influenced other Indian art schools, such as the Mathura school, particularly in the adoption of idealistic realism.

Gandhara art is a testament to the rich cultural interactions and synthesis between India and the Hellenistic world, leaving a lasting legacy on the art and culture of the region.

**Q4. The syncretic nature of the Vijayanagar Empire made significant contributions to the development of art and literature. Substantiate with examples. (10 Marks, 150 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** We can briefly introduce the Vijayanagar empire.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by describing the syncretic nature of the Vijayanagar Empire.

**Conclusion:** conclude with its importance on the modern day or its impact.

**Answer:** The Vijayanagar Kingdom, established by Harihara and Bukka Raya in 1336 and lasting until 1646, was an Indian empire in the southern region known for its syncretic society. The Vijayanagar Empire by blending diverse cultural influences created a syncretic culture which fostered an environment for the development of art and literature.

**The syncretic features of Vijayanagar empires were:**

- **Ethnic and Cultural Mixing:** People from Central Asia, Europe, the Middle East lived together, influenced by cultural exchanges through trade routes extending to Persia, Portugal, Malay Peninsula, and China.
- **Religious Pluralism:** Within Vijayanagar's territories people practiced Hinduism, Jainism, Buddhism, Islam, and Christianity. Cities had mosques, churches, and temples demonstrating religious coexistence and cultural diversity.
- **Architectural blend:** Example - The Hazara Rama temple features carvings depicting scenes from the Ramayana and Mahabharata, alongside Islamic-style arches and domes.
- **Linguistic Plurality:** The empire accommodated speakers of Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Sanskrit, Kannada, and other languages.
  - Allasani Peddana composed "Manucharitam," in Telugu literature and Amuktamalyada is an epic poem in Telugu composed by Krishnadevaraya.
  - Pampa wrote the "Adipurana," in Kannada, an epic poem that narrates the life of Adinatha, the first Jain Tirthankara.
- **Inclusive Administration:** Despite Hindu rulers, Muslims held administrative positions, as documented by Barbosa.

These examples illustrate how the Vijayanagar Empire's syncretic nature contributed to the flourishing of cultural expression in South India during its zenith.

**Q5: Discuss the contributions of various tribal leaders in India's struggle for independence. Substantiate this with examples from different regions. (10 Marks, 150 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** Start with background or reasons for tribal participation

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlight different tribal revolts and leaders across India, who Participated in freedom struggle.

**Conclusion:** conclude with their contribution in India's freedom struggle.

**Answer:** Tribal communities in India joined the struggle for independence due to exploitation and oppression by British colonial policies, including land annexation, forced labor, and unfair taxation. Their resistance was marked by numerous revolts led by charismatic tribal leaders.

**Contributions of various tribal leaders in India's struggle for independence:**

- **Ahom Revolt:** It took place in Assam in 1828. It was led by Gerdhar Konwar, who led armed insurgency, mobilizing local population, and attacking British posts for stronger control in the Ahom region. .
- **Kol Revolt:** It occurred in the Chota Nagpur plateau, present-day Jharkhand in 1831-1832. It was led by tribal leaders like Buddhu Bhagat and Joa Bhagat. They led an armed rebellion, ambushing British forces, and reclaiming land.

- **Bhil Revolt:** It occurred primarily in the region of Maharashtra, Gujarat and Rajasthan during the early 19th century. It was led by tribal leaders like Sewaram and others, who led armed rebellion, attacking British installations, and resisting revenue collection.
- **Birsa Munda of Jharkhand** led the Munda Rebellion (1899-1900) against British exploitation and the zamindari system, seeking to establish Munda Raj and remove British rule.
- **Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu from Bihar** initiated the Santhal Rebellion (1855-1856) against oppressive British policies and zamindars, mobilizing around 60,000 Santhals to fight for their rights.
- **Alluri Sitarama Raju of Andhra Pradesh** led the Rampa Rebellion (1922-1924), opposing British laws that restricted the freedom of tribal people in forest areas, and was known for his guerrilla warfare tactics.

The contributions of these tribal leaders and their revolts were crucial in challenging British colonial authority and sowing the seeds of resistance which played a significant role in India's freedom struggle.

#### Additional Information:

- **Tantya Bhil of Madhya Pradesh** fought against British exploitation and tax policies in the late 19th century, earning the nickname "Indian Robin Hood" for redistributing wealth from the British to the poor.
- **Jatra Bhagat of Jharkhand** initiated the Tana Bhagat movement in 1914, aiming to establish a tribal state and resist British colonial rule.
- **Rani Gaidinliu (Manipur, Nagaland):** Led Naga movement against British rule and paralyzing government activities, promoting indigenous culture and independence.

**Q6: 'Women issues were central to the socio-religious reform discourse.' In this context, highlight the contribution of women leaders of the 19th-century to the emancipation of women. (10 Marks, 150 Words)**

#### Approach to the answer:

**Introduction:** Start with brief background of 19<sup>th</sup> century socio-economic reforms.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlight contributions of 19<sup>th</sup> century women leaders.

**Conclusion:** conclude with summarizing the topic.

**Answer:** The 19th century in India saw a major socio-religious reform movement that focused on women's issues. Women leaders of this period were instrumental in advocating for women's emancipation and transforming the socio-cultural landscape.

#### Contributions of 19th-Century Women Leaders

- **Savitribai Phule:** She along with her husband Jyotirao Phule, established the first school for girls in Pune in 1848. Her efforts were instrumental in breaking the barriers to women's education.
- **Pandita Ramabai:** She founded the Arya Mahila Samaj in 1882 to promote the cause of women's education and prevent child marriages.
- **Sister Nivedita:** She was an Irish social worker who became a disciple of Swami Vivekananda. Nivedita established a girls' school in Kolkata, focusing on providing quality education to women and empowering them to become self-reliant.
- **Rassundari Devi:** She in her autobiography, "Aamar Jiban" (My Life), shed light on the struggles and inner lives of women during that era. Through her writing, she challenged the norms and inspired women to pursue their intellectual and literary interests.
- **Swarnakumari Devi:** She, a member of the Tagore family, founded the "Sakhi Samiti," an organization creating a supportive network for women to achieve self-reliance and social standing.
- **Begum Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain:** Begum Rokeya in her work "Sultana's Dream," a feminist utopian novella that envisioned a world where women ruled and enjoyed equal rights.
- **Tarabai Shinde (1850-1910):** She authored "Stri Purush Tulana" in 1882. This work is considered one of the earliest critiques of the patriarchal system and gender inequalities in India.

The women leaders of the 19<sup>th</sup> century addressed critical issues such as education, social justice, and economic independence, inspired efforts toward achieving gender equality and women's empowerment.

**Additional Information:**

- **Pandita Ramabai** also established the **Mukti Mission** in 1889, a refuge for destitute women and widows, providing them with shelter, education, and vocational training.
- **Begum Rokeya** also established the **Sakhawat Memorial Girls' School in Kolkata** in 1911, which aimed at providing quality education to Muslim girls, challenging the societal norms.

**Q7: The Home Rule Movement significantly influenced Gandhi's 1919 satyagraha movement. Analyze (10 Marks, 150 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** We can introduce the answer by either explaining the home rule league movement (like objective, leaders involved etc.)

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by how Gandhi's 1919 Satyagraha Movement was influenced by home rule movement.

**Conclusion:** conclude with how both the home rule league and Gandhian movements (using the home rule league's tactics) impacted the national freedom struggle.

**Answer:** The Home Rule Movement led by figures like Annie Besant and BG Tilak, emerged as India's response to the First World War. The Home Rule Movement significantly influenced Gandhi's 1919 Satyagraha movement by laying the groundwork for mass mobilization and non-violent resistance against British colonial rule in India.

**It was influenced by Home Rule Movement for several reasons:**

- **Shift in Leadership:** The Home Rule Movement shifted focus from educated elites to the masses, diverging from the path set by the Moderates. Leaders like Annie Besant and BG Tilak became very popular and gained wide support.
- **Political legitimacy:** The widespread support for the Home Rule Movement lent political legitimacy to the demand for self-governance.
- **Urban-Rural Connection:** It established links between urban centers and rural areas, crucial for later mass mobilization during the national movement.
- **Nurturing Nationalism:** The movement encouraged a new generation of strong nationalists, including famous leaders like Jawaharlal Nehru, S.C. Bose, Lala Lajpat Rai, etc.
- **Preparation for Gandhian Methods:** It taught people about Gandhi's non-violent resistance methods, as promoted by leaders like BG Tilak.
- **Congress Unity:** Efforts by Tilak and Besant, like bringing together Moderates and Extremists in Lucknow in 1916, made the Congress party stronger and more effective in fighting for Indian independence.

The Home Rule Movement added new ideas to India's fight for independence, laid down the foundation for Gandhi's 1919 satyagraha movement by broadening political awareness, promoting non-violent resistance, fostering national unity, and articulating the demand for self-governance.

**Q8: Critically examine the conditions that necessitated the imposition of National Emergency in 1975. (10 Marks, 150 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** We can introduce the answer by writing in brief about National Emergency.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlighting various conditions that necessitated declaration of emergency then mention critics' perspective on the imposition of emergency.

**Conclusion:** Conclude with post – emergency efforts to strengthen democracy.

**Answer:** In 1975, a 21-month-long emergency was declared in India on the grounds of “internal disturbances”, is one of the most controversial events in Indian political history.

The declaration was justified by various conditions:

- **Economic Conditions:**
  - Wartime economic stress from the 1971 war.
  - Agrarian crisis due to monsoon failures in 1972-73.
  - The 1973 oil crisis led to a rise in import bills.
  - Commodity prices increased by 23% in 1973 and 30% in 1974.
  - These factors cumulatively led to mass discontent and demonstrations against the government.
- **Rise of Anarchist Tendencies:** Example - J.P. Narayan's call for "Sampoorna Kranti" (total revolution), including a directive to the armed forces to disobey the elected government.
- **Internal and External Threats:** There were perceived threats of subversive activities aimed at toppling the elected government through extra-constitutional means.
- **Governance Paralysis:** Recurring strikes and protests had paralyzed governance and the economy.
  - Example: The 1974 railway strike, which was declared illegal by the government.

Critics' Perspective on the Imposition of Emergency:

- **Democratic Procedures Bypassed:** The imposition of the emergency was a without taking cabinet in confidence or going against democratic procedures and processes.
- **Suppression of Protests:** Critics argue that the emergency was declared to crush protests, particularly those led by the youth.
  - Examples: Nav Nirman movement in Gujarat and student protests in Bihar.
- **Centralization of Power:** The 38th, 39th, and 42nd constitutional amendment acts led to the further centralization of power under the executive.
- **Weakening of Institutions:** Government Machinery was misused to crush individual liberties, example the freedom of the press was curtailed.
- **Judicial Tussle:**
  - In 1973, the government superseded three Supreme Court judges to appoint A N Ray as the Chief Justice of India.
  - The Allahabad High Court's verdict in the Raj Narain vs Indira Gandhi case nullified Indira Gandhi's election.
- **Shah Commission Findings:** The Commission found that the act of declaring the emergency was not commensurate with the perceived economic and political crises, rather it was for vested interests and political survival.

After the Emergency ended in 1977, the Janata Party government was elected which took measures to restore democratic processes and civil liberties. The 44th Amendment Act was passed in 1978 to prevent misuse of emergency powers, ensuring greater checks and balances on executive authority.

**Q9. The American Civil War effectively embodied and achieved the principles of the American Revolution. Analyze.** (10 Marks, 150 Words)

**Approach to the answer:**

**Decoding the question:** This question expects to analysis how the American Civil War embodied and realized the principles of the American Revolution, emphasizing the connection between the two historical events.

**Introduction:** Start with brief background about American revolution.

**Body:** Address the body by highlighting the ideals of the American Revolution and then mention how these ideals achieved through American Civil War.

**Conclusion:** Conclude by summarizing the topic.

**Answer:** The American Revolution stands as a pivotal moment in world history, delivering a severe blow to mercantilism and colonialism. It transcended into a symbol of liberation and individual freedom, establishing foundational ideals for modern democracy.

### Ideals of the American Revolution:

- **Pioneering Democracy:** The world witnessed the establishment of the first democratic government with a written constitution.
- **Montesquieu's Model of Democracy:** Democracy with a separation of powers, inspired by the ideas of French thinker Montesquieu, was instituted.
- **Bill of Rights:** The Bill of Rights was introduced, ensuring fundamental rights for the citizens of the newly formed United States of America.
- **War Against Colonial Domination:** Beyond being a war against England, the revolution fought against aristocracy and reactionary elements, leading to a transformation in the political, social, and economic structure of the United States. Capitalism took firm roots.

### American Civil War (1861-65):

- **Root Cause - Attitude Towards Slavery:** The differences in the stance on slavery emerged as the root cause of the American Civil War, influencing economic and political dynamics.

### Ideals of American revolution is achieved in American Civil War through following ways:

- **Abolition of Slavery:** The 13th Amendment to the Constitution of the USA abolished slavery nationwide.
- **Inclusive Constitution:** The 14th Amendment defined citizenship inclusively, encompassing all persons born or naturalized in the United States.
- **Establishment of Federal State:** The supremacy of the nation was affirmed, putting to rest the doctrine of state sovereignty, and solidifying the perpetual nature of the Union.

The American Civil War realized the structural aspects of the American Revolution, establishing an organic democracy. However, the full devolution of democratic rights took an additional century, evolving through subsequent democratic movements in the USA.

### Q10. To what extent the Treaty of Versailles was responsible for the outbreak of World War II?

(10 Marks, 150 Words)

#### Approach to the answer:

**Decoding the question:** This question requires an assessment of the extent to which the Treaty of Versailles contributed to the onset of World War II. It seeks an analysis of the treaty's role in shaping geopolitical conditions.

**Introduction:** Briefly mention the preceding conditions in which the Treaty of Versailles was signed.

**Body:** Bring out the contentious provisions in the treaty that instigated WW-II and, highlight other factors responsible for WW-II.

**Conclusion:** Conclude by summarizing the topic.

**Answer:** The Treaty of Versailles, signed in 1919 at the end of World War I, is often considered one of the factors that contributed to the outbreak of World War II. While it is not the sole cause, it played a significant role in fostering conditions that contributed to the rise of Adolf Hitler and the aggression of Nazi Germany.

#### Treaty of Versailles was responsible for the outbreak of World War II:

- **Harsh Terms:** Imposed harsh penalties on Germany, including territorial losses, disarmament, and heavy reparations.
- **Economic Hardship:** Economic hardships resulted from reparations, leading to hyperinflation and severe economic instability.
- **Demilitarization:** The treaty's demilitarization clauses weakened Germany militarily, exacerbating feelings of national vulnerability and discontent.
- **Humiliation:** Many Germans viewed these measures as humiliating and unjust, fostering resentment and a desire for revenge.

**Other factors responsible for the outbreak of World War II:**

- **Failure of the League of Nations:** It was established by the Treaty of Versailles to maintain peace, but the League failed to prevent aggressive actions by fascist regimes in the 1930s.
- **Rise of Hitler and Nazi Germany:** Hitler capitalized on economic hardships and perceived injustices of the Treaty of Versailles. He promised to overturn the treaty and restore German pride.
- **Policy of Appeasement:** Britain and France pursued appeasement policies by allowing Hitler's annexations of Austria and the Sudetenland. This policy emboldened Hitler and led to further aggression.
- **Global Economic Depression:** The 1930s depression caused widespread unemployment, poverty, and social unrest worldwide. This Economic hardship led to political instability and provided fertile ground for extremist ideologies such as Nazis.

While the Treaty of Versailles contributed to the conditions that allowed World War II to occur, it is important to note that other factors also played crucial roles, such as the global economic depression, the appeasement policies of the 1930s, and the failure of diplomatic efforts to prevent the aggression of Nazi Germany.

**Q11: The Shakas-Kushans introduced new elements into Indian culture, significantly enriching its cultural fabric. Elucidate** (15 Marks, 250 Words)

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** Give a brief about Shakas-Kushanas rule in India.

**Body:** Address the demand under two headings 1) Contribution of Shakas in the development of India's culture and 2) Contribution of Kushanas in the development of India's culture. Think about their contribution in various dimensions of culture.

**Conclusion:** Summarizes the contribution of Shakas and Kushanas or Conclude with the impact it had on the future development and enrichment of India's culture.

**Answer:** The Shakas and Kushanas were nomads from Central Asia who established their rule in northwestern India during the first few centuries CE. They brought with them their own culture and traditions, which eventually blended with the existing Indian culture, leading to a significant enrichment of Indian culture.

**SHAKAS added new ingredients to Indian culture:**

- **Art and Architecture:** Shakas influenced the development of Indian art, particularly the Gandhara school of art. They also introduced the use of the horseshoe arch.
- **Language:** They brought languages like Bactrian and Kharoshthi, which influenced Indian languages like Sanskrit.
- **Religion:** They contributed to spread of Buddhism and built monasteries & stupas like the Shanti Stupa in Rajgir. Vasu Doorjamb Inscription - mentions the construction of Temple for Vasudev at Mathura.
- **Literary Sources:** Junagarh Prashasti of Rudradaman - a historical record of the restoration work of a reservoir known as "Sudarshana Lake".
- **Coinage:** They issued coins with inscriptions in Gold and Silver which gives insights into their rules and economy.
- **Trade:** The Shakas were involved in extensive trade with the Roman Empire and China. This helped exchange of ideas and philosophies which contributed to the growth of Indian culture.
- **Cuisine:** The Shakas introduced introduced new spices, including coriander and cumin which eventually became integral to Indian cuisine.

**KUSHANAS added new ingredients to Indian culture:**

- **Art and Architecture:** They patronized Gandhara and Mathura school of art. They blended Greek, Roman, Persian, and Indian styles that had an enduring impact on Indian art.

- **Religion:** They were instrumental in development of Mahayana School of Buddhism and instrumental in the spread of Buddhism in China and eastern Asia.
  - They built Kanishka Stupa in Peshawar.
  - They patronized fourth Buddhist council at Kashmir.
  - Kanishka minted coins with Buddha's name
  - Kanishka's court adorned by Buddhist scholar Ashvaghosha- author of Buddhacharita and Sariputraprakarana
- **Language:** They encouraged the use of Greek and Sanskrit, which became the languages of administration and culture respectively.
- **Coinage:** They issued gold coins in large numbers, which was a sign of flourishing economy during their rule. Vima Kadphises-first Kushana Emperor to issue Gold Coins.
- **Trade:** They used to control Silk route which helped to establish India as a hub of economic activity and contributed to the growth of its culture.

The Shakas and Kushans played a significant role in enriching Indian culture by introducing new ideas, practices, and traditions. Their influence can still be seen in art, architecture, customs, language and religion of Indian culture making them an important part of India's cultural heritage.

**Q12: The emergence of Jainism and Buddhism had significant impact on the development of architecture in ancient and medieval India. Substantiate (15 Marks, 250 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** Start with a brief about Buddhist and Jain Philosophies and highlight their influence over the development of architecture.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlight under two heading 1) Impact of Jainism on the development of architecture – by taking various components of architecture and showing influence of Jainism 2) Impact of Buddhism on the development of architecture of that time

**Conclusion:** Summarizes the contribution done by Jain and Buddhist philosophy on the development of architecture.

**Answer:** Buddhism and Jainism emphasize non-violence, truthfulness, and compassion towards all living beings. As these religions grew in popularity, their ethical and spiritual beliefs significantly influenced the design and construction of religious buildings.

**Impact of Jainism on Architecture:**

- **Natural Materials:** Jains used materials like wood, timber, and mud to avoid harming living beings, following their principle of non-violence (ahimsa). Example: Statue of Gomateshwara complex.
- **Marble and Stone:** Jain buildings often used marble and stone to symbolize austerity and detachment. Examples: Khajuraho and Dilwara temples.
- **Intricate Carvings:** Jain temples feature detailed carvings and sculptures from Jain mythology, showcasing their love for aesthetics and beauty. Examples: Dilwara and Khajuraho temples.
- **Jain Caves:** These caves were designed for meditation and contemplation, providing a peaceful environment for spiritual practice. Examples: Ellora and Aihole caves.

**Impact of Buddhism on Architecture:**

- **Stupas:** Large dome-shaped structures enshrining Buddha's relics, symbolizing impermanence and interconnectedness. Examples: Sanchi and Sarnath Stupas.
- **Chaitya Halls:** These halls reflect compassion with columns and panels symbolizing interdependence. Examples: Chaityas at Karle and Kanheri caves.
- **Rock-Cut Caves:** Decorated with sculptures and carvings of Buddhist figures and mythology, reflecting Buddhist aesthetics. Examples: Ajanta and Ellora caves.
- **Natural Materials:** Buddhist buildings often used locally sourced materials like stone, brick, and timber to harmonize with nature. Examples: Ajanta and Kanheri caves.

Overall, the Jainism and Buddhist philosophies influenced the use of natural materials, the design of buildings, and the emphasis on aesthetics and balance. Today, Jain and Buddhist architecture are among the most beautiful and iconic examples of Indian architectural heritage.

**Q13: "Mughal painting is a rich amalgamation of different cultural influences." Discuss how the Mughal School represented a synthesis of Persian, Indian and European styles. (15 marks, 250 words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Decode the question:** The question asks to explain how Mughal painting blended Persian, Indian, and European artistic elements, illustrating this synthesis with specific examples from notable Mughal artworks.

**Introduction:** Introduce in brief about Mughal Painting.

**Body:** In the body highlight the elements used from Persian, Indian and European painting used in Mughal Painting.

**Conclusion:** Conclude with summarizing the topic.

**Answer:** The Mughal School of painting originated during the reign of Akbar and evolved under the patronage of subsequent Mughal rulers. The Mughal style evolved through a synthesis of the Safavid school of Persian painting, the indigenous Indian style and the European style.

**Persian Elements in Mughal Paintings:**

- **Miniature Style:** The miniature style of Mughal painting was an extension of Persian miniature style.
- **Themes from Persian Literature:** Mughal paintings often depicted themes from Persian fables, with short stories featuring animal characters conveying moral lessons.
- **Decorated Borders and Elevated Viewpoints:** The tradition of using richly decorated borders and elevated viewpoints continued in Mughal painting.
- **Use of Colors:** The introduction of Peacock blue and gold in Mughal illustrations was influenced by Persian painting.
- **Calligraphy:** The use of extensive calligraphy along the borders, often written in Persian, was another Persian influence.
- Humayun was influenced by Persian art and invited painters **Mir Sayyid Ali** and **Abd al-Samad** to his court in India. They played a crucial role in establishing the Mughal school of painting.
  - Abd al-Samad contributed to major projects like the "**Hamzanama**" in Akbar's court.

**Indian Elements in Mughal Paintings:**

- **Realism:** Mughal paintings became more realistic than Persian paintings due to Indian influence.
- **Portraits and Natural Elements:** The trend of painting portraits and natural elements like animals was influenced by Indian art. **Jahangir**, for example, commissioned many realistic paintings of birds, animals, and flowers.
- **Depiction of Hindu Deities:** The depiction of Hindu gods and goddesses in Mughal paintings was a local influence.
  - **Dasvant** a Mughal painter in the court of Akbar, painted illustration of folk tales called **Razm-nameh** i.e. **Mahabharata**.
- **Themes from Indian Literature:** Themes and stories in works like the **Tuti-Nama**, which contained over 250 miniature paintings, were derived from the 12th-century **Sanskrit anthology Sukasaptati**.
- **Three-Dimensional Effects:** The flat effect of Persian style was replaced by the roundedness of the Indian brush, giving pictures a three-dimensional effect.

**European Elements in Mughal Paintings**

- **Realism and Shading:** Portraits of Mughal emperors like Jahangir and Shah Jahan show realistic facial features and three-dimensional effects achieved through shading, a technique inspired by European art.
- **Influence of Christianity:** The halo around Jahangir's head is reminiscent of Christian iconography, signifying divinity and sanctity.

- **Introduction of Oil Painting Techniques:** The influence of oil painting techniques, introduced by European artists **Bichitr**.
- **Portraiture Style:** The painting employs European portraiture styles, with a focus on individualism and realistic depiction of physical features.
  - **Example:** "Emperor Shah Jahan with His Son Dara Shikoh" by Murar
- **Depiction of European Instruments and Objects:** European musical instruments and scientific instruments like globes and astrolabes are depicted, reflecting the influence of European material culture.
  - **Example:** "Emperor Jahangir Weighs Prince Khurram" by Manohar; "Jahangir Holding a Globe" by Abu'l Hasan

However, later emperors like Aurangzeb did not patronize art, leading to a mass dispersal of painters to provinces, which contributed to the rise of Rajput and Pahari schools of painting and the eventual decline of Mughal paintings.

**Q14: Why did the East India Company (EIC) succeed in establishing rule over India, while efforts by other European powers failed to secure a firm foothold in the country? (15 Marks, 250 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** We can introduce the answer by explaining how British were amongst the many European colonists that came to India.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlighting in detail as to why the British colonial enterprise succeed in securing rule over India while efforts from other European powers failed.

**Conclusion:** Conclude with summarising the EIC rule over Indian Sub-continent.

**Answer:** Since the early 16<sup>th</sup> century, various colonial powers sought influence in India, with the British eventually emerging as the most successful, despite not being the first to arrive:

- **Portuguese Arrival:** Vasco Da Gama led the Portuguese to Calicut in 1498, marking the beginning of European maritime trade in India.
- **Dutch Presence:** Cornelis De Houtman's expedition landed in Sumatra and Bantam in 1596, establishing Dutch trade routes that competed with Portuguese interests.
- **Early English Attempts:** Captain Hawkins sought permission from Jahangir for a British factory in Surat in 1608, but it was not granted until English trade began in Masulipatnam in 1611.
- **Danish Influence:** The Danish established a factory in Tranquebar in 1620, aiming to compete in the Indian trade market.
- **French Engagement:** The French set up their first factory in Surat in 1668, joining the competition among European powers for Indian trade dominance.

**East India Company (EIC) succeeding where others faltered due to several key factors:**

- **Efficiency of the East India Company:** Unlike their counterparts, the English East India Company operated with an elected board of directors and active shareholder involvement, ensuring efficient management and accountability.
- **Naval Superiority:** The British possessed the largest and most advanced navy of the time, which proved decisive in conflicts against Portuguese and French forces in India.
- **Economic Advantages:** The Industrial Revolution gave Britain a technological edge, enabling innovations like the spinning Jenny and steam engine that bolstered its economic prowess.
- **Effective use of debt markets** also funded military campaigns without draining domestic resources.
- **Leadership Excellence:** Leaders such as Eyre Coote and Robert Clive demonstrated strategic brilliance in conflicts like the Second Carnatic War, securing British interests against formidable opponents.
- **Strategic Goals:** Unlike some European powers focused on religious expansion, the British prioritized territorial and economic gains,

- **EIC's Trade Monopoly:** The EIC securing advantageous treaties like the Treaty of Surat (1775) and Treaty of Allahabad (1765) with local rulers, granting them territorial and economic concessions.
- **Strategic Alliances:** The EIC strategically formed alliances with Indian rulers thereby gaining local support and legitimacy.
- **Strategic Fortresses and Ports:** Control over key ports like Bombay, Madras, and Calcutta facilitated trade and military dominance, enabling the EIC to exert influence across the subcontinent.

The East India Company's conquest of India stands as a pivotal chapter in colonial history. Through strategic alliances, military prowess, and economic dominance, it surpassed European rivals to establish lasting control over the subcontinent.

**Q15: The ideology of the "white man's burden" thinly veiled the realities of a despotic Raj that continuously impoverished the country. Comment** (15 Marks, 250 Words)

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** We can introduce the answer by describing the ideology of white man's burden.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlighting the various arguments of white man's burden as beneficial aspects of the British raj. Next, list arguments on how the acts of the colonial regime impoverished India.

**Conclusion:** Conclude the answer by highlighting how the real nature of colonial exploitation of India was unveiled by nationalists.

**Answer:** During their rule in colonial India, the British positioned themselves as paternal figures, making decisions for the benefit of Indians while denying them the freedom to govern themselves.

This stance, justified by the "White man's burden" ideology – it was used to justify colonialism as a moral duty of the Europeans to civilize and uplift the so-called "backward" societies.

**Under this veil of benevolence, the British implemented various reforms:**

- They enforced socio-religious changes like abolishing sati and encouraging widow remarriage.
- Christian missionaries aimed to reform Indian society morally and convert people from what they saw as superstitious religions.
- Educational institutions like Calcutta Madrasa and Sanskrit College were established to promote native education, though primarily benefiting the upper and middle classes.
- Administrative reforms included systems like subsidiary alliances, the doctrine of lapse, and dyarchy to improve governance.
- Infrastructural projects such as railways were touted to integrate India internally.

**Despite these acts of kindness, the British rule had devastating consequences for India:**

- Forced agricultural commercialization led to exploitation and unfair land revenue policies.
- India became a market for British goods and a source of raw materials, leading to deindustrialization and rural poverty.
- Indians were performing menial jobs in governance, reduced to puppets under British control.
- The British exacerbated communal divisions, through Bengal Partition of 1906, reserved electoral, etc.
- Calamities like the Bengal famine was ignored, highlighting the absence of compassionate governance.
- The colonial regime cultivated a loyal middle-class intelligentsia, minimizing Indian participation in decision-making and facilitating wealth drain from the country.

The British portrayal of benevolence masked self-interest and perpetuated a system of exploitation and oppression for Indians. Early nationalists and Gandhian movements ultimately challenged this narrative, exposing the economic exploitation and uniting Indians in their struggle for independence.

**Q16: Different land revenue systems were introduced by the British colonial regime in India for economic, political, and administrative reasons. Discuss (15 Marks, 250 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** We can introduce the answer by describing the colonial land revenue systems.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlighting first list the reasons for having different land revenue systems. Next, list the social and economic impacts of the land revenue systems.

**Conclusion:** Conclude with a summarised view on the impact of the British land revenue systems in India.

**Answer:** The British colonial regime introduced various land revenue systems in India to consolidate their economic control, stabilize their political dominance, and streamline administrative functions. Systems like Zamindari, Ryotwari, and Mahalwari, facilitated not only revenue extraction but also reshaped India's agrarian landscape and socio-economic structure.

**Zamindari System:**

- **Economic Reasons:** Introduced by Lord Cornwallis in Bengal, Bihar, and Odisha, it fixed land revenue permanently, ensuring stable income.
- **Political Reasons:** Aimed to create a loyal Zamindari class supporting British rule, aligning their interests with the colonial regime to strengthen political control.
- **Administrative Reasons:** Simplified revenue collection by dealing with a few Zamindars, reducing administrative costs and efforts.

**Ryotwari System:**

- **Economic Reasons:** Introduced by Sir Thomas Munro in Madras, Bombay, and Assam, it assessed revenue directly from cultivators based on land quality, incentivizing productivity improvements.
- **Political Reasons:** Reduced intermediaries' influence, giving direct control over peasants and integrating the local economy with the colonial administration.
- **Administrative Reasons:** Required detailed surveys, facilitating better land management and allowing a flexible, responsive revenue system.

**Mahalwari System**

- **Economic Reasons**
  - Introduced by Holt Mackenzie in the North-Western Provinces, Central India, and Punjab, it periodically fixed revenue from village groups (Mahals), allowing adjustments based on agricultural conditions.
- **Political Reasons:** Preserved traditional village communities and leaders, ensuring smoother governance and local cooperation, enhancing British influence.
- **Administrative Reasons:** Combined features of Permanent Settlement and Ryotwari, allowing flexibility and better control of diverse regions through local adaptation.

The British land revenue systems in India were strategically designed and implemented to serve multiple purposes. While the specific approaches varied by region, all systems fundamentally altered India's agrarian structure, serving the broader colonial objective of consolidating British rule in the subcontinent.

**Q17: Highlight the key features of Lord Ripon's new approach. What were the long-term effects of the period of his governorship? (15 Marks, 250 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** We can introduce the answer in brief with Ripon's viceroyship.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlighting discuss in detail how his approach differed from his predecessors then discuss the long-term impacts of the period of his Viceroyship.

**Conclusion:** Conclude the answer by highlighting the positive conclusion.

**Lord Ripon** is often referred to as the "Father of Local Self-Government" in India. His tenure marked a significant shift in British colonial policy, emphasizing liberal reforms and Indian participation in governance. His approach was characterized by a series of progressive measures that aimed to promote self-governance, education, and social reform in India.

**Key features of Lord Ripon's new approach:**

- **Local Self-Government:** Introduced the Resolution on Local Self-Government in 1882, creating municipal committees and district boards to involve Indians in local administration.
- **Education Reforms:** Implemented Hunter Commission recommendations, expanding primary education and emphasizing vernacular languages.
- **Press Freedom:** Repealed the Vernacular Press Act of 1878, leading to a surge in Indian-language newspapers like 'Kesari' and 'Bengalee'.
- **Financial Decentralization:** 'Provincial Contract System' of 1881 granted provinces autonomy in managing departments like education, medical services, and roads.
- **Factory Act of 1881:** Prohibited child labor under age 7 and limited working hours for children
- **Ilbert Bill Controversy:** Proposed the Ilbert Bill in 1883 to allow Indian judges to try cases involving Europeans, highlighting racial discrimination in the judicial system.

**Long-term effects of Ripon's governorship:**

- **Political Awakening:** His policies sparked Indian political awareness and fostered nationalist sentiment, notably inspiring the formation of the Indian National Conference in Calcutta in 1883.
- **Seeds of Democracy:** Laid the foundation for local self-government in India and prepared the groundwork for democratic participation, evolving into the robust Panchayati Raj system.
- **Social Reform:** Emphasized social justice, education, and nurtured India's educated middle class, which later became instrumental in the independence movement.
- **Freedom of Speech and Expression:** He supported free speech, enabling a strong, independent press that further aided in India's freedom struggle.
- **Racial Equality:** The Ilbert Bill controversy exposed racial discrimination, sparking demands for equality.

Ripon's tenure was brief but marked by progressive reforms in local governance, decentralization of finances, and social welfare, shaping India's future reforms. While some of his policies faced opposition and limited implementation, they undeniably marked a turning point in British India and served as steppingstone for the development of an independent, democratic India.

**Q18: Before Gandhi's arrival, the national movement was characterized by a narrow social and political base, concentrated class interests, and limited demands. In what ways did Mahatma Gandhi change the nature of the freedom struggle? (15 Marks, 250 Words)**

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** We can introduce the answer by highlighting the arrival of Gandhi ji in the national freedom struggle.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlighting Characteristics of Pre-Gandhian National Movement and discuss how Mahatma Gandhi gave the national movement a different character.

**Conclusion:** Conclude the answer by highlighting the future event.

**Answer:** Mahatma Gandhi's return to India in 1915 marked a transformative period in the national freedom struggle. His socio-political experiences in South Africa brought a new dimension to the Indian movement, which had previously been characterized by a narrow social and political base, concentrated class interests, and limited demands.

**Characteristics of Pre-Gandhian National Movement:**

- **Narrow Social & Political Base:** The early national movement was led by moderates who restricted their efforts to the middle-class intelligentsia, limiting its impact.
- **Concentrated Class Interests:** Prior to Gandhi, the movement largely reflected the interests of specific groups, such as landlords.
- **Narrow Demands:** The pre-Gandhi demands were focusing on issues like Indianization of government services. Gandhi broadened the agenda to include wider social reforms and the upliftment of the masses.
- **Western Educated Intellectuals:** Leadership was predominantly Western-educated and disconnected from the masses.
- **Absence of Organizational Coherence:** The movement lacked coherence, with moderates' ineffective strategies and extremists' unfocused militancy.

**Gandhi's entry redefined the movement:**

- **Mass Orientation:** Gandhi shifted the focus to the masses by taking up their issues such as plight of the farmers.
  - Example the Champaran and Kheda Satyagrahas, which mobilized widespread support.
- **Mainstreaming of marginalized groups:** Gandhi brought marginalized groups into the movement, like Harijans and women, encouraging their active participation in movements like the Civil Disobedience and Non-Cooperation Movements.
- **Emphasis on Means Over End:** Gandhi's ethical approach prioritized non-violence and truth (Satyagraha), stressing that the means were as important as the end.
  - Example he called off the Non-Cooperation Movement after the Chauri Chaura incident to avoid violence.
- **Gandhian Ideas:** His concepts of Satyagraha and Swaraj (self-governance) emphasized peaceful protest and self-reliance, promoting Khadi and village industries.
- **Nation Building:** Gandhi's inclusive vision fostered Hindu-Muslim unity and campaigned against untouchability, essential for nation-building.

Gandhi's methods and principles not only united diverse sections of society but also redefined the strategy of India's quest for independence.

**Q19: Why is 1960s referred to as the 'dangerous decade'? How did India overcome the challenges faced during this period?** (15 marks, 250 words)

**Approach to the answer:**

**Introduction:** We can introduce the answer by highlighting the background of a dangerous decade.

**Body:** Address the demand of the question by highlighting the different threats/challenges faced by India during this period then mention the measures taken by India to surmount these challenges.

**Conclusion:** Conclude the answer by summarizing the topic.

**Answer:** The 1960s in India, often referred to as a "dangerous decade," were marked by significant political, social, and economic challenges that threatened the nation's democracy and sovereignty.

**Political Instability**

- **Leadership Transitions:** The deaths of Prime Ministers Jawaharlal Nehru in 1964 and Lal Bahadur Shastri in 1966 led to concerns about succession in the nascent nation.
- **Rise of Regional Parties:** The emergence of regional parties fragmented power centers, complicating the political landscape.
- **Political Defections:** Frequent defections, epitomized by the phrase "aaya ram gaya ram," destabilized the political environment.

**Economic Turmoil**

- **Agricultural Decline:** Food shortages due to declining agricultural production, failed monsoons, and droughts intensified economic distress.
- **Low Growth and High Inflation:** The Indian economy experienced low growth rates, high inflation, and a precarious balance of payments situation.
- **Industrial and Export Decline:** A drop in industrial production and exports, coupled with rising military expenditures, strained the economy.

**Social Unrest**

- **Linguistic Agitations:** Agitations for linguistic supremacy, such as those led by the DMK in Tamil Nadu and the Andhra Pradesh People's Association (APPA), threatened national unity.
- **Anti-Caste Movements:** The resurgence of anti-caste movements saw Dalits demanding greater rights and social equality.

**Security Threats**

- **Wars with Neighbors:** India engaged in wars with China in 1962 and Pakistan in 1965, straining national security.
- **Internal Security Challenges:** Anti-state movements like the Naxalite movement and the Mizo National Front's independence demand in 1966 posed significant internal threats.

**Government Reforms to address these challenges:**

- **Institutional Response to Security Threats:** Formation of the Border Security Force (BSF) and the Research and Analysis Wing (RAW) to enhance security.
- **Green Revolution:** Initiatives to boost agricultural productivity through high-yield seeds, fertilizers, and irrigation, leading to self-sufficiency in food production and rural employment.
- **Import Substitution Policy:** Encouragement of domestic production to reduce imports and trade deficits through incentives and subsidies to domestic industries.
- **Currency Devaluation:** The 1966 devaluation of the rupee by 36.5% to address the balance of payments crisis and boost export earnings.
- **Bank Nationalization:** The 1969 nationalization of 14 major banks to expand banking services in rural areas and promote financial inclusion.

Despite initial pessimism, India successfully navigated through the "dangerous decade," laying the foundation for more robust and dynamic growth in the future.

**Q20. Highlight the key factors that precipitated the Russian Revolution of 1917 and discuss its far-reaching consequences.** (15 Marks, 250 Words)

**Approach to the answer:**

**Decode the question:** In this question you have to Identify and analyze the main causes of the 1917 Russian Revolution and examine its significant and lasting impacts on Russian society, economy, and global political dynamics.

**Introduction:** Introduce the answer with brief background of Russian Revolution.

**Body:** In the body, discuss the factors led to Russian Revolution and followed by its consequences.

**Conclusion:** Conclude by contextualizing socialist movements among various revolutions.

**Answer:** The Russian Revolution of 1917 consists of two major events: the February Revolution, which ended the rule of the Czar and established a Provisional Government, and the October Revolution, in which the Bolsheviks overthrew the Provisional Government and established a communist state in Russia.

**Factors that led to the Russian Revolution of 1917:**

- **Presence of a Feudal Society:** In the 19th century, Russia remained under the feudal autocratic rule of the Czars, characterized by an inflexible, privileged, and inefficient bureaucracy.
- **Nature of the Industrial Revolution in Russia and Worker Discontent:** Foreign investment focused on quick profits while Russian capitalists cut wages to compete, leading to harsh conditions and no political rights for workers.
- **Deplorable Condition of the Peasants:** Small landholdings with no capital to develop them, combined with heavy dues, led to significant unrest among the peasants.
- **Effects of Participation in World War I:** Soaring inflation, food scarcity, and high casualties made life miserable for the people, resulting in the February Revolution.
- **Role of Intellectuals:** Liberal ideas from Western Europe and the works of Tolstoy, Turgenev, and Dostoevsky highlighted the shortcomings of Russian life.
  - A political awakening led by Socialist ideas from Karl Marx, Maxim Gorky, and Bakunin also influenced peasants and workers.

**Consequences of the Russian Revolution of 1917:**

- **Establishment of the First Socialist State:** The autocratic rule of the Czar, the aristocracy, and the church was overthrown. The Bolshevik Party, led by Lenin, formed the new government by establishing the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics (USSR).
- **Emergence of a New Economic Order:** Private property was abolished. The state adopted economic planning to build a technologically advanced economy.
- **Formation of the Comintern:** The Comintern was established to promote international revolutions, enabling a global communist movement.
- **Thrust for Decolonization:** Soviet Russia was the first European country to openly support the independence of all nations from foreign rule, providing impetus to colonies struggling for national independence.

The Russian Revolution of 1917 reshaped Russia's political landscape, establishing a socialist state and influencing global politics, economy, and decolonization movements, marking a pivotal moment in world history.